

# Romain Sickenberg

## Backend-Software Engineer

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Backend Software Engineer with **5+ years** building and maintaining business-critical web applications and **REST APIs** with **PHP**, **Symfony**, **Laravel**, **React** and **Docker**.

Hands-on across application design, component integration and deployment (**CI/CD**), including code review, production releases and technical leadership of medium-sized projects.

Work authorization: Swiss Citizen. Available now.

## EXPERIENCE

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### Full-Stack Software Developer

03.2024 - 12.2025

#### Academic Work SA

IT Consulting for diverse clients via Academic Work.

- Designed a decoupled backend/frontend architecture for **SIL Lausanne** and built the **Docker** base platform underpinning most of their in-house solutions (**Python**, **Django**, **Vue**, **React**).
  - Shipped a **React (Next.js)** application with **GitHub Actions CI/CD**, **Docker** containerization and automated deployments to Jelastic.
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### Backend Software Engineer

10.2021 - 02.2023

#### Antistatique SA

From Junior to mid-level Software Engineer & highest skill jump !

- Built and maintained enterprise **Symfony 6** applications and their **REST APIs (API Platform)**, on **PHP 7.4/8.0** with **Doctrine ORM**, **PostgreSQL**, **Redis** caching and **Elasticsearch** indexing.
  - Led a five-developer team as **PHP Lead Developer** on a 3-4 month **Symfony** build for Colis du Coeur, shipping v1 of a state-machine-driven workflow for volunteer distribution centres.
  - Delivered and maintained six CMS builds - five **Drupal**, one **WordPress**.
  - Cut **GitHub Actions** execution time by **75%** through dependency caching and workflow optimization.
  - Led code reviews and owned technical delivery on small to medium-sized projects, including a client platform hosted on **AWS**, enforcing maintainability and development standards.
  - Built a small internal tool on a **serverless Firebase** backend with a **Vue.js** front end.
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### Junior Backend Software Engineer

02.2021 - 10.2021

#### Ilem Group

IT Consulting to an external client named Berdoz Vision & Audition.

- Secured and migrated a business-critical ERP serving **20 retail stores** to a newer **PHP** version, then helped build its **Laravel** replacement.
  - Configured a fleet of **44 iPads** and set up CI servers running **Codeception** and **Cypress** test suites.
  - Hardened security and developed critical components of the in-house CRM used across that same store network.
  - Built internal tooling for automated testing, monitoring and deployment, with **Sentry** for error tracking.
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### Apprentice Software Engineer

06.2016 - 06.2020

#### Liip AG

- Developed and extended internal web applications in **PHP** and **JavaScript**.
- Shipped features in an **Agile** team using **Git**, **Scrum** and modern web development practices.
- Developed custom **Moodle** plugins with **PHP 5.4**.

## Personal Breaks & Side Activities

- Security agent at Securitas AG - part-time, event sector. 07.2023 - 03.2024
- Planned career break - solo world travel and personal development. 02.2023 - 06.2023
- Swiss Armed Forces - mandatory military service. 07.2020 - 11.2020

## SKILLS

### BACKEND

PHP, Python, Node.js, C#, Java, REST APIs

### DATABASES

PostgreSQL, MySQL, MariaDB, Prisma / Supabase, Redis, Elasticsearch

### TOOLS

Git, GitLab, Composer, Jira, Confluence & Scrum, Sentry, Bash

### CLOUD & DEVOPS

Docker, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Linux, Apache & Nginx, Google Cloud Platform (GCP), AWS, Firebase, Serverless

### FRONTEND

TypeScript & JavaScript, React, Next.js, Nuxt.js, NPM & Bun, HTML5 & CSS, Sass, Tailwind CSS, Alpine.js

### MOBILE

Swift 5 (iOS, WatchOS, Combine, Intents, Swift UI, etc.)

## EDUCATION

Swiss Confederation | EPSIC @ Lausanne & CFPT @ Geneva 08.2016 - 07.2020

Federal VET Diploma in Information Technology (CFC)

GPA: 4.4

## PROJECTS

Tesla Companion 01.2018 - 01.2023

Paid iOS & WatchOS App to work around Tesla cars.

- Built and published a commercial iOS and watchOS application integrating Tesla APIs reaching over 1,000 daily active users and ranking #5 in the App Store Trips category.

Fort-To-Nite 01.2017 - 01.2019

Free iOS wiki around Fortnite with live in-game shop indications and Django back-end.

- Fortnite companion app with 100,000+ downloads, 4.6\* rating (340+ reviews) and a peak ranking of #19 in the App Store Reference category.

## AWARDS

EPFL Hackathon AR/VR Game Experiences 12.2019 - 12.2019

RA \ VR Hackathon

Built a "digital museum" in Virtual reality. Won the first place in VR experiences, built with SteamVR and Unity.

## LANGUAGES

French: Native (C2) · English: Fluent (C2) · German: Intermediate (B1)